Challenge Brief

Template for challenge partners · Since AI Hackathon 2026 · 6–8 Nov 2026, Turku

This template helps you define a clear, buildable challenge for the hackathon. Fill in each section below — the more concrete the problem and the evaluation criteria, the better the prototypes you receive. You can return it to us as is, and we are happy to help shape it into a ready event challenge.

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Challenge partner (company)

Fonecta Oy · Fonecta Connect (Hitta Connect in Sweden)

01 Challenge Title

A short, memorable name for the challenge. Example: “Automated support ticket routing.”

Connect Suggests – Customer Approves

Connect ehdottaa – asiakas hyväksyy

02 Problem Statement

What business or technical problem should be solved? Describe the context, why it matters, and the main pain points.

Fonecta Connect helps local businesses get found online. It keeps their information – opening hours, photos, reviews – accurate and up to date in 35+ channels such as Google, Apple Maps and Bing. The same Nordic SaaS runs in Sweden as Hitta Connect and will soon launch in Norway.

Today the customer logs in and does everything themselves: business details, photos, review replies and exception hours. Many forget or have no time. Search results then show old information, and their customers walk to a closed door.

Connect is changing direction. It follows each customer’s situation, notices when something needs doing and sends a ready-made suggestion. The customer approves it with one click, and Connect makes the change.

Your task: build a working demo of Connect contacting a customer – “Update your opening hours like this.” The demo must show the whole chain:

1. **Detect.** How does Connect conclude that the opening hours need to change? Which data does it use?
2. **Suggest.** Which hours does Connect propose, and why exactly those?
3. **Contact.** The customer gets a message (email, SMS, WhatsApp or another channel) that states the suggestion and the reason clearly.
4. **Decide.** The customer approves, edits or declines. No login needed.
5. **Apply.** The approved change is written to Connect’s backend (Yext API), and the customer gets a confirmation of where the new hours now show.

Example message
Hi Kahvila Aurora! All Saints' Day is on Saturday 31 Oct. Last year you were open 10–15 that day, but no exception hours have been added this year, so Google now shows your regular Saturday hours (9–18).
We suggest: Sat 31 Oct 10–15 [Approve] [Edit] [No thanks]

Think Nordic. Connect is a Nordic product, so Swedish and Norwegian data sources are welcome – build for Finland, Sweden and Norway.

Wrong hours also cost visibility: a business with missing or outdated hours can drop out of 'open now' searches, and search demand may peak around holidays – exactly when hours are most likely to be wrong. The search and view statistics in the dataset can help decide which suggestions matter most.

03 Guiding Question

One question that focuses the challenge. Example: "How might we use AI to predict equipment failures before they happen?"

How might Connect use AI to notice when a business's opening hours are about to be wrong, propose the right hours with a clear reason, and get the owner's approval in one tap – so that no customer walks to a closed door?

04 Recommended AI Approaches *Optional*

Any relevant technologies, models or methods — for example NLP for text analysis, classification, knowledge graphs, agents, or RAG.

- **Pattern learning:** last year's exceptions, the customer's own past decisions and what similar businesses nearby do.
- **Rules + ML with confidence:** send only when confident; otherwise ask, or stay quiet.
- **Visibility-aware priority:** use search and view statistics to decide which suggestions to send first.
- **NLP / LLMs:** read reviews ("closed although Google said open") and write short, clear messages in Finnish, Swedish, Norwegian and English.
- **Learning from feedback:** approve / edit / decline improves the next suggestion; standing permission for recurring changes.
- **Guardrails:** the customer has the last word, nothing is published without approval or standing permission, and every suggestion keeps its reasons (audit trail).

05 Dataset or API Provided *If any*

Describe any data or resources you provide: format, a link if ready, and sample size. If none, state what builders should expect.

At Since AI, challenges can be built with synthetic, anonymized or public data — no personal data is required.

1 Yext sandbox – one per team (Fonecta)
Yext is the backend on which Connect's own UI is built. Fonecta sets up a separate Yext sandbox

account (test customer) for every team, so teams can explore what Yext enables and demo the real write path. Fonecta delivers each team's credentials at the start of the hackathon.

API docs: https://docs.yext.com/docs/managementapis/introduction/overview-policies-and-conventions/ – the key part is the **Knowledge Graph** (entities, hours, holidayHours). Sandbox base URL: https://sbx-api.yextapis.com

2 Synthetic starter dataset (Since AI): Connect Suggests – Nordic opening-hours simulator v1.1

3,000 synthetic Connect customers in Finland, Sweden and Norway with almost three years of history, in Yext API format: regular and holiday hours, exception-hour history, Google user edit suggestions, 60,000 reviews (fi/sv/nb/en), daily search and view statistics, shopping-centre hours, anonymised peer benchmarks, a 2025 pilot log of 3,031 suggestions with owner decisions, holiday calendars, school breaks, local events and weather.

Includes a local Yext mock API, an owner simulator (approve / edit / decline), a baseline and a scoring script. Code written against the mock works with the sandbox by changing the base URL. Note: the sandbox has the same API but not the same data – its test businesses have no exception-hour history, so use the mock for detection and the sandbox to demo the write path. Download link shared with all teams at kickoff (ZIP, 16 MB). Code MIT, data CC BY 4.0.

3 Public data (optional)

Holiday calendars, Helsinki LinkedEvents, open weather data (FMI, SMHI, MET Norway), open business registers (PRH, Brønnøysund). No real customer data is used. Keep sandbox credentials out of public repositories and videos.

06 Evaluation Criteria

How should solutions be judged? What matters most — for example accuracy, scalability, usability, or business impact?

- **Suggestion quality:** Is the suggestion sensible and backed by data? The scoring script measures it on hidden test data.
- **Customer experience:** Does a busy entrepreneur understand the message at once, and is approving easy?
- **Reliability:** Does the customer always have the last word? How are wrong suggestions prevented?
- **Extensibility:** Which other, similar use cases would the same loop serve? (Automatic posts and review replies are already in production or on the roadmap.)
- **Learning:** Does Connect learn from the customer's decisions, so that the next suggestion is better after an edit or a decline? Can recurring changes get standing permission – "Handle public holidays from now on without asking"?

The demo must show all five steps. A complete chain beats a perfect single step.

07 Submission Format

What deliverables do you expect? For example a demo video, pitch slides, a code repository, or documentation.

- **Working demo** of the five steps – live or as a 2–3 minute video.
- **Code repository** with a README: how to run it, data sources used, and third-party libraries and their

licences (no GPL/AGPL components without Fonecta's written approval).

- **Data sources:** in the README, name the 3–5 data sources that matter most for your solution, where Connect would get them in production, and what you tried that didn't work.
- **Customer messages:** include your final customer messages as text.
- **No history:** show how your solution behaves for a customer with no history / no previous actions.
- **Short pitch deck:** problem, solution, how it learns, results, next steps.
- **Bonus:** replace at least one dataset file with a live source and tell us what you learned – coverage, quality, gaps.
- **Optional:** predictions file for the scoring script. A README template and live-source guide are in the dataset's docs folder.

08 Point of Contact

Name, email and preferred contact method for questions during the hackathon.

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Tiia Halme, Platform Manager (Yext, sandbox, API) · tiia.halme@fonecta.com · Discord: tiia_fonecta

Preferred: the Fonecta channel on the Since AI Discord. On site Fri–Sat; Q&A point at Joki on Sat 9–12 and 14:30–18. No Q&A on Sunday.